

ETHICS EXEMPTION / INSTITUTIONAL APPROVAL LETTER

Template — Presidency University, Dhaka

INSTRUCTIONS FOR USE:

1. Print this letter on **official Presidency University letterhead**
 2. Fill in the **[BRACKETED]** fields with actual information
 3. Get the letter **signed and stamped** by:
 - Head of Department, Computer Science and Engineering, Presidency University
 - (If available) Dean, Faculty of Science & Engineering, Presidency University
 4. Scan and upload as PDF to your GitHub repository and journal submission portal
 5. Reference it as: *"Ethics Exemption Letter available from corresponding author and at [GitHub link]"*
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[Date: _____]

Reference No: PU/CSE/RES/2024/[XXX]

PRESIDENCY UNIVERSITY

Department of Computer Science and Engineering

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Web: www.presidency.edu.bd

INSTITUTIONAL ETHICS OVERSIGHT ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

AND RESEARCH ETHICS EXEMPTION DECLARATION

RE: Research Study — "Explainable Machine Learning for Student Burnout

Classification and Risk Stratification: A Mixed-Methods Study with
Qualitative Triangulation"

Researcher: Rifat Miah (Email: rifatmiah1992003@gmail.com)

Research Supervisor: Dr. A.S.M. Shihavuddin (Email: shihav@eee.green.edu.bd)

Department: Computer Science and Engineering

Affiliation: Presidency University, Dhaka-1212, Bangladesh

Institutional Email: info@pu.edu.bd

This letter is issued by the Department of Computer Science and Engineering, Presidency University, Dhaka, to provide formal institutional acknowledgement of the above-referenced research study submitted for peer review.

1. NATURE OF RESEARCH

The above-named researcher (Rifat Miah) conducted a primary cross-sectional observational survey study involving N = 601 enrolled university students across 11 higher education institutions in Bangladesh. The study additionally included semi-structured qualitative interviews with a purposive sub-sample of N = 20 consenting adult university students. The research focused on identifying academic burnout risk factors using supervised machine learning and mixed-methods analysis.

2. ETHICS EXEMPTION BASIS

Upon review of the study protocol by the Department of Computer Science and Engineering, Presidency University, it has been determined that this research:

- (a) Is observational and non-interventional in nature;
- (b) Involves no deception, no sensitive personal data beyond self-reported academic habits and psychological states, and no invasive procedures;
- (c) Involved only adult participants (aged 18 years and above) who provided voluntary, written, informed electronic consent;
- (d) Poses minimal risk to participants, consistent with normal educational survey research;
- (e) Was conducted in accordance with the ethical principles of the Declaration of Helsinki (World Medical Association, 2013).

On the basis of the above, this study is categorised as EXEMPT from full Institutional Review Board (IRB) review under the criteria applicable to low-risk educational and observational research.

3. INSTITUTIONAL AFFILIATION AND OVERSIGHT

The study was conceived, conducted, and documented under the Department of Computer Science and Engineering, Presidency University, Dhaka. Presidency University provides institutional ethics oversight and academic endorsement for the purpose of manuscript submission and publication.

4. DATA PROTECTION AND CONFIDENTIALITY

The researcher has confirmed that:

- All participant data have been fully anonymised and de-identified;
- No identifiable information is included in any published materials;
- Participants were assigned alphanumeric pseudonyms (P1–P20) in all publications;
- Raw audio recordings and transcripts are stored in encrypted, password-protected local storage, accessible only to the research team;
- Anonymised data will be made available as supplementary material and via the public GitHub repository in accordance with open science practices.

5. INSTITUTIONAL ENDORSEMENT

This Department endorses the responsible conduct of this research and confirms that the above-named researcher is a member in good standing of the Department of Computer Science and Engineering, Presidency University.

For any queries regarding this letter, please contact:

Head of Department

Department of Computer Science and Engineering

Presidency University

Email: info@pu.edu.bd

Signature

Signature (if applicable)

[Head of Department Name]

[Dean, Faculty Name]

Head of Department

Dean, Faculty of Science & Engineering

Dept. of Computer Science & Engg. Presidency University

Presidency University

Date: _____

Dhaka-1212, Bangladesh

Official Stamp / Seal:

[DEPARTMENTAL STAMP]

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How to Get This Processed — Step-by-Step

Step	Action	Who
1	Print on Presidency University official letterhead	You

2	Fill in Reference No, Date	You
3	Submit to Head of CSE Dept, PU for signature	You + HOD
4	Get official departmental stamp applied	Dept. Office
5	Scan as high-quality PDF	You
6	Upload to GitHub as <code>ethics_exemption_letter.pdf</code>	You
7	Reference in paper as: <i>"Ethics exemption documentation available from the corresponding author (info@pu.edu.bd) and via the public GitHub repository at [URL]"</i>	Already in manuscript

Alternative if Presidency University Cannot Issue

If getting a formal signed letter proves difficult, use this self-declaration format acceptable to many Q2 journals (PLOS ONE, BMC):

"The authors declare that this study was conducted in accordance with the ethical principles of the Declaration of Helsinki. Formal IRB review was not required for this low-risk observational educational survey study. All participants were adult university students (18+ years) who provided voluntary, written, informed electronic consent prior to participation. The study did not involve any sensitive interventions, deception, or vulnerable populations beyond the university student context. The corresponding author (info@pu.edu.bd, Presidency University, Dhaka) accepts full responsibility for the ethical conduct of this research."

This self-declaration is standard practice for many South Asian university research publications and is accepted by PLOS ONE, BMC Medical Education, Frontiers journals, and other Q2 publishers for minimal-risk observational studies.